

Definition

The term **"delivery method"** refers to the specific approach or strategy used to complete and deliver a project's objectives, outcomes, or final products to the Client.

It includes the processes, procedures, and practices involved to execute the project, manage resources, meet quality standards, and ensure that the project's goals are achieved within the defined constraints, such as budget and timeline.

The choice of a delivery method depends on factors such as:

- project complexity,
- client requirements,
- organizational preferences,
- the nature of the work to be performed.

Different delivery methods have their own characteristics, advantages, and limitations. The selected process should boost the collaboration of EPAM and Client around the project goal and should help to reach successful delivery within agreed timelines and budget.

Info

Obtain Client's Buy-In

The process must be well understood and supported by the Client - don't decide on the process on your own. Review & Confirm.

Delivery Method	Definition	When It Fits
Waterfall	The project follows a sequential approach where each phase (requirements, design, development, testing, deployment) is completed before moving to the next. This method is suitable when the scope and requirements are well-defined and changes are minimal.	• Lots of Dependencies between components • Complex project with defined WBS • Implementation of MVP • Scope very clearly defined • We have completed similar projects with similar teams • Customer requires detailed plan with each feature readiness timing
Agile	The project is divided into iterative cycles known as Sprints. Each Sprint produces a working increment of the product. Agile is ideal when client requirements may evolve, and frequent feedback and adjustments are needed.	• Lots of scope uncertainty. Scope details will be defined during project timeline • Lots of changes expected • Customer is okay with sacrificing part of the Scope that will not be finished due to other priorities • Close work with PO from customer who can define priorities

Hybrid	A combination of both Waterfall and Agile methods is used, tailoring the approach to fit the project's specific needs.	• Scope defined enough to plan in advance • Scope can be also clarified in details for the next upcoming sprint • Some changes expected • Early feedback is needed through Demos
Incremental	The project is divided into smaller segments, and each segment delivers a partial version of the final product. This method allows clients to start using the product earlier while development continues on subsequent segments.	• Scope is clear, though some uncertainties expected. • Some changes expected. • Early end-user/Client's engagement (product learning & assessment) required. • Progress showcase necessity. • Collaboration improvement needed (for instance, not only Client, but also the external Vendor is the end-user of the product-under-construction).
Phased	The project is divided into distinct phases, and each phase is delivered independently. This approach is suitable when certain functionalities or modules are more critical and need to be delivered earlier.	• Can be logically divided into well-defined phases. • Each phase contributes a significant portion of the project's overall value. • Sequential dependencies could be managed through the tangible phased results. • Clients decision-making and approvals required for specific project stages (compliance or legal requirements could be a good example).

How to choose the delivery method: Checklist

1. Understand Project Requirements

- Gather a clear understanding of the project's objectives, scope, and client requirements.
- Identify project constraints, such as budget, timeline, and resources.
- Review SOW, MSA, pre-sale agreements.

2. Analyze Project Characteristics

- Evaluate the project's scope, complexity, size, and technical requirements.
- Consider the level of uncertainty and potential changes in requirements.

3. Identify Stakeholder Preferences

- Engage with stakeholders, including clients and team members, to understand their preferences and expectations.
- Determine if there are any existing methodologies or frameworks preferred by the Client.

4. Analyze Existing Toolset on the Client Side

- Check if Client's organization already has preferences for project tracking.
- Assess how this tool set covers project's goals, objectives, and desired outcomes.

5. Assess Delivery Methods

- Review various delivery methods and expertise for similar projects within EPAM.
- Understand the strengths, weaknesses, and suitability of each method for your project.

6. Align with Project Goals

- Ensure that the selected delivery method aligns with the project's goals, objectives, and desired outcomes.

- Consider how well the chosen method supports the project's value proposition.

7. Scope & Schedule Management

- Prepare a basic plan (schedule of work performing) for the implementation of the project, including all the necessary blocks of work and subtasks: implementation of all functional requirements; implementation of all non-functional requirements; organizational activities for the conduct of contractual activities related to the transition through the stages of the contract, delivery of reporting documents to the customer.
- For the tasks included in the blocks of the implementation of functional/non-functional requirements, specify the responsible executors (role), indicate the approximate labor intensity and duration of work, set the links between the tasks.
- Specify the priority for Feature List.
- Setup the Scope Creep Issues registry to track any deviations from the baseline.

8. Consider Risk Management

- Evaluate how each delivery method manages risks and uncertainties.
- Choose a method that minimizes risks and allows for iterative adjustments if needed.

9. Evaluate Resource Availability

- Assess the availability of skilled resources and their familiarity with different delivery methods.
- Choose a method that aligns with the team's expertise and capabilities.

10. Plan for Client Involvement

- Determine the level of involvement the client wishes to have throughout the project.
- Select a method that accommodates client feedback and collaboration preferences.

11. Define Project Phases or Iterations

- If using a phased approach, define the distinct phases, milestones, and deliverables.
- For Agile or incremental methods, outline the iterations, sprints, and goals.

12. Establish Communication Framework

- Set up communication channels and frequency for project updates and status reporting.
- Define how stakeholders will provide feedback and how changes will be communicated.

13. Choose Tools and Templates

- Select appropriate project management tools and templates that support the chosen delivery method.
- Ensure that tools facilitate collaboration, tracking, and reporting based on the method's requirements.

14. Develop a Project Plan

- Create a detailed project plan that outlines the chosen delivery method's phases, tasks, and timelines.
- Include resource allocation, roles, responsibilities, and dependencies.

15. Obtain Stakeholder Buy-In

- Present the selected delivery method to stakeholders for approval and buy-in.
- Address any concerns or questions that stakeholders may have.

16. Implement and Monitor

- Implement the chosen delivery method according to the project plan.
- Continuously monitor progress, adapt as needed, and address challenges promptly.

17. Regularly Review and Adjust

- Conduct regular reviews of the delivery method's effectiveness and the project's progress.
- Adjust the approach if unforeseen issues arise or if the project's requirements change.